

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Team Leader (Supervisor) _____	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	Combination Vacuum Truck & CCTV Survey TasWater Inspection Program	Asset Numbers:	
SWMS prepared Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: Aug 2026 unless required earlier		Project & Location:	
Signature: _____ 			
Approval to use this SWMS: “I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use”			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	<u></u> Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Residual Risk Class
2.0 Set out work area.  	Struck by Vehicle or construction plant.	1	1. Barricade the work area, to prevent inadvertent access by public. 2. Implement relevant Traffic Guidance Scheme (TGS) and ensure pedestrians have a designated, safe passage around the worksite. 3. Ensure all operational flashing lights and reversing beepers on all plant are functional. 4. Implement Traffic Guidance Scheme (TGS) and Traffic Management Plan (TMP) NOTE: When working in higher risk areas additional traffic controllers may be required to implement more complex TGS's – Consult Management immediately if the need is identified Traffic Guidance Scheme Number: (Please enter TGS Number)	Supervisor Operator/Traffic Controller Supervisor/Traffic Controller Supervisor	2
3.0 Operation-Combination Vacuum truck 	Unsafe machine potential for injury to operator or bystanders	1	1. Pre-start checks are to be completed prior to operation and are to be submitted on our WHS monitor platform. 2. All safety devices: emergency stops, reversing alarms, rotating flashing lights, communication device (radio), seat belts and fire extinguisher are effective and operational. 3. Mobile plant operators hold the appropriate licenses and competencies for the plant they are required to operate. 4. Mobile plant and vehicle operators always find a stationary position in a safe place prior to handling a mobile phone. 5. Safety related deficiencies are resolved before equipment is put into operation. 6. Mobile plant is always switched off and braking mechanisms are applied before being left unoccupied. 7. TasWater customers made aware for potential of blowbacks through community correspondence prior to site arrival	Operators	2

[illegible]

			4. If gas or electrical indicators are known, conduct BYDA enquiry and review Tas Gas Networks & TasNetworks Before You Dig Australia 5. All CCTV Operators and Combination Vacuum Truck Operators are to remain vigilant when conducting surveys or root cutting in areas where underground electrical distribution infrastructure is present. Services or Mains may have been drilled through the infrastructure being cleaned or inspected creating a crossbore hazard. 6. If a blockage in the drain is prevalent first attempt to clear the blockage with a non-destructive jetting head (i.e. Penetrator) if the blockage fails to clear, refer to DBYD's for potential Electrical main/service alignments that may compromise the drain 7. If there is evidence of underground power or natural gas in the area of a blockage on the program refer to Management PROJECT HOLD POINT management may facilitate underground asset locations or a CCTV survey on the perceived blockage prior to moving forward 8. Ensure our Emergency Procedures are available for reference in the event of an emergency also ensure the projects Emergency Response Plan (ERP) is available for reference.	Supervisor Operators Supervisor All	
6.0 Opening manholes/pits	Manual handling Open manholes/pits	1	1. Refer to Paneltec <i>SWP-30 Opening Manholes – Safe Handling</i> 2. Install Barriers/Man Hole Guard to remove Live Edge/Fall Zone	Operators	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Residual Risk Class
	Risk of Fall – Working at Heights TasWater Permit Required	1	1. In all instances where the placement of Manhole Guards/Barricades can not be facilitated to remove the live edge/fall zone the following shall apply: 2. PROJECT HOLD POINT REFER: TasWater Supervisor for Working at Heights Permit & Rescue Plan. 3. Once a permit is authorised and obtained work can proceed complying with the requirements of the Working at Heights Permit & Rescue Plan.	Operators Supervisor	2
7.0 Confined Space Entry (If required - Permit Entry Only*) 	Low Oxygen, Hazardous Gases, Biological Hazards, Engulfment Slips, Trips and Falls TasWater Permit Required		1. Entry to a confined space is not envisioned to be a regular occurrence throughout the program, however, entry may be required during the program for the following reasons: • Jetting Head Deployment • Jetting Head Retrieval • Camera Deployment • Camera Retrieval 2. Entry to the confined space shall only take place after a <i>Confined Space Entry Permit and Rescue Plan</i> has been obtained from the TasWater Supervisor PROJECT HOLD POINT 3. Once a permit is authorised and obtained, entry to the confined space shall only be undertaken by accredited trained personnel complying with the requirements of the Confined Space Entry Permit and Rescue Plan wearing the following PPE: • Highly Visible Workwear – Long Pants & Shirt (Sleeves Down) • Safety Gum Boots • Hard Hat – No caps underneath • Safety Glasses - AS/NZS1337 • Hearing Protection (Where Required) • P2 Respirator/Face Shield • Disposable Coveralls • Construction Gloves Cut Factor >4 & Glove Clip	Supervisor TasWater Operators	

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	1. Risk Control Measure	Responsible	Residual Risk Class
8.0 Operating the Combination vacuum truck OPERATION OF MOBILE PLANT 	Injury to operator or bystanders – high pressure- dirt and stones can be flicked around.	1	1. All workers are to wear required PPE in accordance with TasWater Policy: • Highly Visible Workwear – Long Pants & Shirt (Sleeves Down) • Safety Boots • Hard Hat – No caps underneath • Safety Glasses - AS/NZS1337 • Hearing Protection (Where Required) • Face Shield in addition to Safety Glasses when cutting, grinding, using compressed air or <u>high-pressure water jetting</u> • Construction Gloves Cut Factor >4 & Glove Clip 2. Keep operating area clear of public access 3. Stay alert and beware of the force of the water pressure coming out the end of the hose and when using the vacuum hose be aware of the suction pressure. 4. Do not overreach or stand on unstable supports. 5. Never aim the jet in the direction of persons or animals as the water jet comes out of the nozzle at high speed with high pressure. 6. Do not leave the operating vacuum unattended. If the vacuum is not required switch off. 7. Follow directions as per the operations manual. 8. When cleaning pipes etc. the hose must first be in the pipe prior to activating the control.	Supervisor Operator All Operators	2
9.0 Unloading & Positioning & Using Motorised Easement Hose Reel	Injury to operator or bystanders – crush injury, high pressure- dirt and stones can be flicked around.	1	1. Perform daily pre-start on the hose reel 2. Always Unload and Load the Easement Reel on level ground, with the trailer attached to the tow vehicle using the ramps fitted to the trailer, Chock the trailer tyres. 3. Always operate the Easement Reel according to the operating instructions 4. Avoid turning the reel on slopes. If you must turn, turn slowly. 5. Water pressure should not exceed NP, outlined in the instruction manual. 6. Never place any part of your body in front of or near the high-pressure water jets 7. Position the Easement Reel so the hose reel is Centre of pit opening to the directly opposite side of planned pipe entry for the sewer hose.	Operators	2

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			uncontrolled water or debris spray. 9. Never point pressure spray at any person.		
11.0 Use of Hydro Powered Root Cutter	Hand injury Bodily injury from cutting blade	1	1. Ensure Crossbore checks have been conducted (See 4.0 Above) 2. Use appropriate nozzle for first run of cleaning 3. If obstruction doesn't clear and roots are evident in water then cutting head can be prepared. 4. Wear gloves when handling cutting blade. 5. Do not operate cutter until safely positioned inside the drain. 6. Maintain a grip on jetting hose to feel the reaction force of cutter.	Operators	2
12.0 Hose blockage	Entrapped hand, Manual handling	2	1. Ensure vacuum is isolated prior to unblocking. 2. Keep hands clear of hose. 3. Use two operators when handling hose when clearing blockages.	Operators	3

ADDITIONAL HAZARDS IDENTIFIED	CONTROL MEASURES FOR RISK MITIGATION

FURTHER ON SITE SCENARIOS	DOCUMENTS FOR PROJECT REFERENCE	TASWATER DOCUMENT REFERENCE NUMBER
Emergencies - Gas Strike , Electrical Etc.	TasWater Emergency Response Plan	TBA
Community Relations, Complaints Etc.	TasWater Community & Stakeholder Plan	TBA
Environmental Controls, Incidents Etc.	TasWater Site Environmental Plan	TBA
Pre-Start	TasWater Pre-Start Safety Action Plan	TBA
Pre-Start	TasWater U-Take 5	TBA

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Highly Visible Vests/Workwear	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Sun ring for Hard Hat (UV)	Sunglasses (Approved Safety)	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls
Hard Hat at all Times	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long Sleeves and Pants	Dust masks	Respiratory Helmets if and when required	Face Shield when using jetting hose

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.				
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card				
- TasWater & TasWater Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's) - Site specific requirements (external)	Vehicle License's (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators license's or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Compliance	

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice and Other Guides			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2018	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2018	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2020
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2020
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2018	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2018	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2018	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018
Guide for Managing Risks from High Pressure Water Jetting – Safe Work Aust 2020			

Plant & Equipment for this activity
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - All maintenance issues addressed prior to departure. - Regular servicing as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity
Combination Vacuum Recycler Truck
Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.